

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3244

Name

Adam Poulsen

Emailadam@adampoulsen.co**Gender**

Male

City, state, and country of residence

Sydney, NSW, Australia

Nationality

Australian

When did or will you finish your PhD?

2022

University Education

Doctor of Philosophy (Information Systems). Charles Sturt University. 2022

Bachelor of Computer Science (Honours, 1st class). Charles Sturt University. 2017

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

I had successfully applied for a Science Corps Fellowship in 2021 but decided to pass on the opportunity offered at the Bohol site for two reasons. Namely, circumstances required that I accept a job offer and I could not teach the requested subjects with integrity. At that time, the reason I applied was because I wanted to serve and give back to vulnerable communities. Since then, my desire to serve has only intensified. Currently, I work on research that addresses low-resource settings and inequities in early childhood development, however, I do not feel or see the change in people's lives that we aim to create. In my life, especially during my studies, I have significantly benefited from the generosity of others. I feel a pull to do the same for

others. I am contracted to work with The University of Sydney until December 2024, at which point I wish to embark on volunteer work, with the Philippines or Thailand being my target destinations. Science Corps specifically aligns with my career goals, skillset, and personal values.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

I am applying with the hope of working with CVIF in Bohol, Philippines. I have life and career experience which I believe makes me suitable to work alongside those at Science Corps and CVIF. First, I lived in the Philippines for a year and fell in love with the culture, people, nature, language, food, and values. The Philippines is my second home. Second, I am an interdisciplinary researcher, having researched and published across various topics, namely computer science, information systems, robotics, mobile health, technology design, care values, health ethics, professional ethics, social programs, and early childhood development. Third, I have consistently worked with a diverse range of people and cultures throughout my career, which has equipped me with the skills to work with diverse sets of people abroad. Fourth, my recent work has focused on children in low- and middle-income countries. At present, my research focuses on supporting early childhood development and fostering healthy parent-child interactions in low-resource settings with mobile health technologies. This work has been incredibly humbling, having allowed me to advance my knowledge of the diverse experiences of children, parents, and service providers across the globe, particularly in Southeast Asia, Central Asia, Africa, and the Pacific.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science outreach

As far as possible from science/education

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

Although I am currently an academic, I expect to take a break from academia and engage with ongoing humanitarian work or science outreach in Southeast Asia within the next two years. In the best-case scenario, I hope to obtain a hands-on leadership role along one of these pathways and continue that work in the long term. I am very interested in the following areas for that work: childhood education, community development, environmental protection, and disaster relief work. As aforementioned, I do not feel that my work in academia is making real, tangible changes to better people's lives. I want to use my hands, be in the field, and see and hear from vulnerable communities without the need for a Zoom connection. However, for the next year (until my contract ends), academia has personal advantages that I believe I can translate into my future expected work. My work allows me to engage with diverse people in numerous countries to advance my cultural humility. Further, if I do not obtain an ongoing role in humanitarian or outreach work, postgraduate qualifications will allow me to move in and out of academia (or at least in industry roles) to financially support intermittent volunteer work.

CV/Resume



[ADAM-POULSEN-CV 2023 SEPT.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

A friend or colleague

Any other comments/questions?

I would like to add that last time I applied I was asked to teach psychics, biology, or chemistry. However, I believe that I could teach and research in line with my expertise: computer science and information systems. Specifically, I have an existing, very basic teaching plan (and required resources) in mind already. This would involve educating on computing skills, programming logic and practice, and introductory, basic-level robotics through hands on lessons with children's educational robot kits (some of which are mechanical and do not require electricity), which are cheap and simple.

[Science Corps](#)